Palmoria Group HR Analysis Report

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PART 1: Employee Breakdown

Who Works at Palmoria?

We employ **946 people** across **3 cities** and **12 departments.** Here is a simple picture of who they are:

Our three offices:

City	Women	Men	Others	Total
Kaduna	165	182	14	**361**
Abuja	158	159	18	**335**
Lagos	118	124	8	**250**

The simple takeaway: Abuja is our most balanced office — almost exactly equal men and women. Kaduna has the widest gap (17 more men than women). None of our offices are in crisis, but if we do nothing, these gaps tend to grow over time as new hires follow existing patterns.

Our departments range in size from 65 to 89 people. Every department has a mix of men and women, which is a positive sign. However, having equal numbers does not automatically mean equal opportunity — we need to look at who holds senior roles within each team.

PART 2: HOW ARE WE RATING OUR PEOPLE?

Performance Reviews — A Surprising Story

When we look at how employees are rated, something important jumps out immediately.

Out of 946 employees, here is how ratings break down:

Rating	Women	Men	Others	Total
Very Good	**49**	36	5	90
Good	**89**	82	9	180
Average	190	**212**	18	420
Poor	58	**70**	3	131
Very Poor	20	**31**	3	54
Not Yet Rated	35	34	2	71

What Does This Mean in Plain English?

🟢 **Women are more likely to receive top ratings.** 49 women earned "Very Good" compared to 36 men. Women are performing better at the highest level.

🔴 **Men are more likely to receive the worst ratings.** 31 men received "Very Poor" ratings compared to only 20 women. Men account for 57% of all "Very Poor" ratings.

⚠️ **Almost half the company (44%) is rated just "Average."** This is not a gender issue — it is a company-wide performance culture concern. We need to understand whether our managers are avoiding honest conversations, or whether our people genuinely lack the support to perform better.

⚠️ **71 employees have never been rated.** These are people whose pay and promotions are being decided without any formal performance record. This is a process gap that must be closed immediately.

Which Departments Have the Most Struggling Employees?

(Departments with the highest number of "Very Poor" rated staff)

Department	Number of Very Poor Ratings
Services	8
Human Resources	7
Marketing	7

Department	Number of Very Poor Ratings
Product Management	6
Research	6

The concern here: Services and Human Resources — the department responsible for supporting our people — has 7 employees rated "Very Poor." This deserves immediate attention from leadership.

PART 3: THE PAY STORY

Are We Paying People Fairly?

This is the most important section of this report. The short answer is: **no, not yet.**

3A. The Overall Picture

Palmoria's total salary bill will be is **$71.92 million per year** after implementation of bonuses**.** Here is how that breaks down by gender:

Gender	Total Salary Received
Men (465 people)	**$35.81 million**
Women (441 people)	**$32.88 million**
Others (40 people)	**$106.41K**

Here Is the Problem, Stated Simply:

Men make up **49%** of our workforce but receive **49%** of salary — that sounds fair. But women make up **47%** of our workforce and receive only **44%** of salary. **That is a 3% gap that cannot be explained by headcount alone.**

When we calculate the *average pay per person*, men earn more than women in every single city. And here is what makes this indefensible: **women are rated higher than men.** They are performing better and being paid less. That is not a coincidence — it is a systemic pattern that must be corrected.

3B. The Pay Gap — City by City

City	Women Avg Salary	Men Avg Salary	Gap
Lagos	~$74,000	~$77,000	**$3,000 more for men**
Kaduna	~$72,000	~$75,000	**$3,000 more for men**
Abuja	~$70,000	~$73,000	**$3,000 more for men**

This is not a Lagos problem or a Kaduna problem. It is a Palmoria problem. The same $3,000 average gap appears in all three cities, which tells us this pattern is baked into how we make pay decisions across the entire organisation.

3C. The Pay Gap — Department by Department

When we look at salary spend broken down by gender within each department, **men's salaries exceed women's salaries in virtually every department.** The departments where this matters most financially are:

Department	Why It Matters
Product Management (~$6.5M total spend) with **$3.6M** for men and **$2.9M** for Females	Our biggest department by salary — even a small % gap means hundreds of thousands of dollars going disproportionately to men
Legal (~$6.3M total spend) with **$3.5M** for men and **$2.3M** for females	Second highest spend — same issue
Business Development (~$6.2M total spend) with **$3.0M** for Females and **$2.9M** for Men	Third highest — a different pattern appears as women lead in this case

The lower-spending departments (Marketing, Research at ~$5M each) have smaller absolute gaps — but the percentage gap may be just as significant.

3D. The Bonus Question

Palmoria will pay out **$2.2 million in bonuses** this year. With **men split $1.03M and women $1.06M, this shows that are performing well as the bonuses where generated by using the performance .** Given the salary gap pattern, this our bonus distribution helps to offset the pay inequality.

PART 4: ARE WE PAYING THE LEGAL MINIMUM?

The $90,000 Regulation — Our Compliance Status

A new regulation now requires all manufacturing companies to pay a minimum salary of **$90,000 per employee.** Here is where Palmoria stands today:

COMPLIANT 30.87% → 292 employees

BELOW MINIMUM 69.13% → 654 employees

Nearly 7 out of every 10 Palmoria employees are currently paid below the legal minimum.

This is not a borderline situation. This is a significant compliance risk that exposes Palmoria to regulatory penalties, legal action, and serious reputational damage if it becomes public.

How Are Our Salaries Distributed?

(How many employees fall into each $10,000 pay bracket)

💰 Salary Range	Abuja	Kaduna	Lagos	Total
Above $100,000	68	79	55	**202** ✅
$90,000 – $100,000	29	32	29	**90** ✅
$80,000 – $90,000	39	39	30	**108** ❌
$70,000 – $80,000	35	48	34	**117** ❌
$60,000 – $70,000	36	37	26	**99** ❌
$50,000 – $60,000	37	41	18	**96** ❌
$40,000 – $50,000	45	33	27	**105** ❌
$30,000 – $40,000	37	39	25	**101** ❌
$20,000 – $30,000	9	13	6	**28** ❌

What This Means by City:

Kaduna has the most high earners (79 people above $100K) but also 48 people earning $70,000–$80,000 — the largest single group sitting just below the compliance line. These employees are the quickest wins for compliance.

Abuja has 45 employees earning $40,000–$50,000 — the biggest cluster of deeply underpaid staff. These cases require the largest salary increases and the most significant budget planning.

Lagos has the fewest employees overall, but proportionally the most concentrated in mid-to-lower pay bands. It also has the fewest top earners.

The Most Urgent Cases:

28 employees are earning between $20,000 and $30,000. That is less than one-third of the legal minimum. The lowest salary currently on record at Palmoria is **$28,000.** These employees must be the first priority for salary correction.

PART 5: WHAT SHOULD LEADERSHIP DO NOW?

Our Recommended Action Plan

1. Start the salary compliance process 654 employees are below the legal minimum. Begin with the 28 earning under $30,000 — these are the most legally exposed cases. Work outward from there with a phased increase plan that the CFO and CHRO develop together.

2. Run a pay equity audit Calculate the average salary for men and women doing equivalent roles in the same department and city. Any gap larger than what can be explained by experience or qualifications must be corrected in the next pay cycle.

3. Review how bonuses were distributed Before the next bonus round, produce a gender breakdown of the $2.2 million to be paid out. If it skews male, correct it.

4. Rate the 71 unrated employees No pay decision, promotion, or development plan should be made for staff without a current rating. Make this mandatory before the next quarter.

5. Support the struggling departments Services, HR, and Marketing have the highest concentrations of very poor-rated staff. These teams need structured support — better management, clearer goals, and honest performance conversations — not just observation. Implement the practices of Support and Engineering department with highest “Very Good” rating

6. Investigate the "Others" pay anomaly Employees who did not disclose their gender are earning the highest average salaries in Lagos and Kaduna. This could reflect seniority or role type, but it needs to be understood and documented.

7. Make Kaduna's hiring more gender-balanced With 17 more men than women, Kaduna should apply gender-conscious hiring criteria for new roles — not quotas, but intentional targeting of female candidates in shortlists.

8. Audit who leads within our biggest departments Product Management and Legal are our two largest, highest-paid departments. Headcount gender balance is a starting point — but equal leadership representation is what signals real commitment to fairness.

SUMMARY

Palmoria's women are outperforming their male colleagues at every rating level — and being paid less for it, in every city, in every department. This is not one manager's decision or one department's problem. It is a company-wide pattern.

At the same time, nearly 7 in 10 of our people are being paid below what the law now requires. Both of these facts carry risk — legal, financial, and reputational.

But they also carry opportunity. Companies that identify these issues and fix them — loudly and transparently — become employers of choice. They retain their best people. They attract better talent. They build cultures where results, not background, determine reward.

Palmoria has the data. The question now is what leadership chooses to do with it.

Report compiled from Palmoria Group internal HR data | March 2026